

JKBOSE 2026

CLASS 11TH

THE SUMMER OF THE BEAUTIFUL WHITE HORSE

LECTURE-1

ENGLISH

HUSSAIN SIR



Topics To Covered

- 1 ... lec. 01. (The Summer of the beautiful white horse)
⇒ Detailed Summary.
- 2 ...
⇒ Textual questions.
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- 3 ...
- 4 ...

# The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse



- The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse is a short story written by Armenian-American novelist and playwright William Saroyan. The story <sup>includes</sup> entails a simple narrative of two poor Armenian boys who are very <sup>having a great liking</sup> fond of horses. And in spite of having strong moral ethics of honesty that make their whole tribe distinct, these boys fulfil their wishes by riding a stolen white horse.

⇒ Two Boys ÷ Characters

⇒ 1. Aram → Narrator — 9 years

⇒ 2. Mourad → Aram's cousin →

# The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse

- One morning, around <sup>early morning</sup> dawn, when Aram was nine years old, his <sup>Cheerful-full of joy</sup> fun-spirited cousin Mourad <sup>Knocked</sup> tapped on his window. When Aram looked out of the window, he could not believe what he was seeing – his cousin Mourad was sitting on a beautiful white horse. Mourad asked Aram to come down quickly if he wanted to ride the horse. Aram stood there in <sup>complete great wonder</sup> utter awe and disbelief because there was no way Mourad could <sup>to have</sup> possess such a beautiful white horse.

## The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse

- While his family and his whole tribe suffered from poverty, their <sup>mark</sup> hallmark was honesty. The whole Garoghlanian tribe was known for their honesty for many centuries. They were proud, honest and justice-oriented. There was no way Mourad could have stolen that horse. But given their financial conditions, it was evident that Mourad had not bought the horse – he had stolen it. Aram felt both frightened and <sup>very happy</sup> delighted at the situation. He asked his cousin why he had stolen the horse. Mourad simply asked Aram if he wanted to go for a ride or not.

## The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse

- As Aram got up to dress, he engaged himself in thoughts – trying to justify Mourad's actions. He reasoned that stealing a horse for a ride was not the same as stealing something valuable as money. It was not stealing at all, given how crazy Mourad and Aram were about horses. It would be considered stealing if they offered to sell the horse. It was something they would never do. He <sup>jumped suddenly</sup> leapt down to the yard from the window, and both went riding. The horse went very fast, and Mourad started singing loudly – almost roaring. <sup>making very loud sound</sup>

# The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse

Narrator: Aram



- Aram tells us about his cousin Mourad. Like in every family, Mourad was considered to be the natural descendant of the crazy streak in their tribe – uncle Khosrove. Although Mourad was considered to be the descendant of Uncle Khosrove, his father, Zorab, was nothing but a practical man by nature. Uncle Khosrove was a man of <sup>angry man</sup> furious temper and little patience. He would stop people from saying anything by just roaring at them. His classic response to any situation was to tell the person concerned not to bother about it. It so happened that once Uncle Khosrove's son, Arak, went running to his father in the salon to tell him that their house was on fire. Uncle Khosrove simply roared at his son, telling him to pay no attention to it.

## The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse

- After letting the horse run as much as he could, Mourad asked Aram to get down. He wanted to ride the horse alone. Aram asked Mourad if the latter would let him ride the horse alone. Mourad's reply was that it would be the horse's decision. As Aram saw his cousin kick into the horse and let it burst into a fury of speed, he felt like it was the loveliest thing he had ever seen. Mourad rode the horse across a field over an irrigation ditch and returned five minutes later completely <sup>wet</sup> drenched in sweat. He got off the horse and asked Aram to ride the horse.

## The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse

- Aram got on the horse and realised that the horse was not moving. He felt scared. Mourad instructed him to kick into the horse's muscles. The horse began to run, and Aram did not know how to guide it. Instead of running across the field, the horse ran into the vineyard of Dikran Halabian and started leaping over the vines. After going over seven vines, Aram fell off the horse, and the horse continued running. Mourad and Aram went different ways looking for it, and <sup>mourad</sup> the former returned half an hour later with the horse.

## The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse

- Aram discovered that Mourad had been riding the horse for quite some time. But, when asked about it, Mourad only asked Aram to remember that they started riding the horse that morning. Mourad took the horse to the barn of a deserted vineyard. He informed Aram that it was not easy to get the horse to behave nicely in the beginning, but he had an understanding with horses. Mourad explained that Aram would be able to understand horses when he reached thirteen years of age.

## The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse

- Uncle Khosrove came to Aram's house that afternoon for coffee and cigarettes and sat there remembering the old country. A farmer named John Byro arrived and started talking about his lost white horse. It was stolen a month ago, and he was still not able to find it. As usual, Uncle Khosrove told him not to bother about it. John Byro talked about his plight – he could not operate his surrey without the horse, and his left leg hurt. The horse had cost him sixty dollars. Uncle Khosrove replied sharply retorted that he spat on money and stormed out of the house.

## The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse

- Aram ran to Mourad after hearing this and told him all about John Byro and the horse. He wanted Mourad to return the horse when he had learned to ride properly. Mourad told him that it would take him at least a year to learn riding the horse. Mourad did not want to keep the horse that long and decided that they would return the horse after six months. They took the horse for a ride every morning for two weeks. There seemed to be no improvement in Aram's riding. One morning, they ran into John Byro. Mourad wanted to talk to the farmer, saying he had a way with farmers. John Byro felt that this horse resembled his lost horse and wanted to inspect its teeth. Mourad agreed. John Byro informed Mourad that he would have definitely claimed that horse to be his if he did not know about their family's reputation for honesty.

## The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse

- The next morning, Aram and Mourad took the horse back to John Byro's. The same afternoon, John Byro came to Aram's house in his surrey and showed his found horse to Aram's mother. He informs Aram's mother that the horse is stronger and more well-tempered than before.

## QUESTION



Who is the narrator of the story?

- 1 Mourad
- 2 Uncle Khosrove
- 3 John Byro
- 4 Aram 

## QUESTION



What is the narrator's age in the story?

- 1** 9 years 
- 2** 11 years
- 3** 13 years
- 4** 15 years

## QUESTION



What time of the day did Mourad come to Aram's house?

- 1** Early morning ~~✗~~
- 2** Afternoon
- 3** Midnight
- 4** Late evening

## QUESTION



From which tribe did Aram and Mourad belong?

- 1 Armenian ✓
- 2 Garoghlanian ✗
- 3 Turkish
- 4 Egyptian

## QUESTION



What was the reputation of the Garoghlanian family?

- 1 Rich and generous
- 2 Honest and poor ~~✗~~
- 3 Proud and arrogant
- 4 Wealthy and greedy

## QUESTION



Who was John Byro?

- 1** A farmer ~~XXXX~~
- 2** A blacksmith
- 3** A teacher
- 4** A priest

## QUESTION



What is the main theme of the story?

- 1 Adventure and crime ✕
- 2 Family and jealousy ✕
- 3 Wealth and power ✕
- 4 Honesty, pride, and childhood innocence ✕

## QUESTION



You will probably agree that this story does not have breathless adventure and exciting action. Then what in your opinion makes it interesting?

## ANSWER:

Even though the storyline is not that adventurous, the way in which the entire scene is described by the author makes it very interesting. However, the element that makes it all the more engaging is the smooth flow of emotional narration. This has been addressed from the perspective of a nine-year-old boy. The boy, who is from a poor family, and is known for his morality, cannot fathom that his brother could steal a horse to ride. This in itself is interesting for the boy. Every idea that passes through the mind of the boy after looking at the horse has been romanticized by the writer. Riding the stolen horse and hiding it carefully are great feats of adventure for the two boys. But their family is recognized for their morality, and the same streak is also present in them. After a while, they overcome their desire and return the horse to its rightful owner.

## QUESTION



Did the boys return the horse because they were conscience-stricken or because they were afraid?

## ANSWER:

In the entire story, the boys are characterised as fearless. It was their rage towards the horse that made them steal one horse. When they had the horse for several months, the farmer John Byro visited their house and saw the horse. John Byro recognized his horse but refused to believe that Mourad and Aram had stolen it. He, however, did not say anything to the boys, rather honouring their family for its honesty. This was the circumstance when the conscience-stricken boys decided to return the horse.

## QUESTION



"One day back there in the good old days when I was nine and the world was full of every imaginable kind of magnificence, and life was still a delightful and mysterious dream..." The story begins in a mood of 2019-20 nostalgia. Can you narrate some incident from your childhood that might make an interesting story?

~~ANSWER:~~

Students have to answer this on their own.

H/W

## QUESTION



The story revolves around characters who belong to a tribe in Armenia. Mourad and Aram are members of the Garoghlanian family. Now locate Armenia and Assyria on the atlas and prepare a write-up on the Garoghlanian tribes. You may write about people, their names, traits, geographical and economic features as suggested in the story.

## ANSWER:

H/W ⇒

The Garoghlanian family was an Armenian tribe. Eleven centuries ago, it was the wealthiest tribe in that part of the world. The members of the tribe were recognized for their morality. They ended up settling in regions such as Fresno and California. The Garoghlanian tribe is a group that works in modern conditions while carrying in their mind the values of the past of their native Armenia. They were proud of their family. Honesty was vital, and they had a fair sense of right and wrong.

# Homework



→ write down the  
question given as  
H/W and send it  
in the community .  
fmg

**Thank**  
You